

Sam Wells

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PROFILE

Graduate student in Rural Planning and Development with experience in GIS-based asset management, spatial data organization, and municipal infrastructure records. Skilled in ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, Excel, and applied research methods, with an interest in transportation infrastructure, spatial analysis, and GIS-supported planning.

EDUCATION

University of Guelph

September 2025 – Present

Master of Science in Rural Planning and Development

Guelph, ON

- Cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0 (89%)
- Graduate Student Council Representative, Canadian Institute of Planners Liaison

Wilfrid Laurier University

September 2021 – April 2025

Honours Bachelor of Arts, History with Geography Minor

Waterloo, ON

- Cumulative GPA: $\approx 3.6/4.0$ ($\approx 81\%$)

GIS, RESEARCH & ANALYTICAL EXPERIENCE

- Conducted research and analysis related to municipal planning, rural development, transportation and infrastructure systems, and economic development initiatives through applied academic projects.
- Maintained and organized structured datasets using Excel, ArcGIS Pro, and QGIS to support spatial analysis, mapping, and policy evaluation.
- Performed quantitative and qualitative analysis using census, demographic, and policy datasets to support planning and development initiatives.
- Translated technical research findings into accessible written materials suitable for public and stakeholder audiences.
- Assisted with the preparation of maps, presentation materials, and documentation to support planning, research, and policy-focused projects.

WORK EXPERIENCE

City of Woodstock

April 2026 - Present

Water Records Maintenance

Woodstock, ON

- Maintained and updated over 30 000 municipal infrastructure asset records using MESH, including water valves, curb stops and fire hydrants.
- Assisted with GIS-based asset management by verifying and updating spatial infrastructure data and map locations for municipal water infrastructure assets.

Grand River Conservation Area

June 2022 – September 2025 (Seasonal)

Assistant Head Lifeguard | Lifeguard

Brantford, ON

- Oversaw a team of over 20 lifeguards, ensuring adherence to safety procedures and operational standards.
- Maintained detailed records, reports, and incident documentation to ensure adherence to regulatory requirements.
- Coordinated biweekly training programs to improve skillsets and safety procedures with the lifeguards to ensure National Lifeguard standards.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Data and Office Applications: MS Excel, Word, PowerPoint, Access, MESH
- GIS & Research Software: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, RStudio, SPSS, NVivo, Qualtrics
- Content and Documentation: Report writing, briefing notes, presentation development, document management
- Software and Certifications: Adobe Acrobat, Photoshop, Standard First Aid & CPR-C, G License